

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.22 .11th July 022



NOT PRESUMING HOW GOD WILL ACT

• OUR PASSAGE

- *Matthew 19:13 Then little children were brought to Jesus for him to place his hands on them and pray for them. But the disciples rebuked those who brought them. NIV*

THE LESSON.

■ NOT **PRESUMING** HOW GOD WILL ACT

■ NOT **Predetermining** (determining in advance) WHAT GOD'S ACTION OR RESPONSE WILL BE.

- Presume= to believe something to be true or likely although not certain; OR presuming something that you may not have the right to do so; OR *presuming* that there is an established fundamental order of how things should happen.

Matthew 19:13-15

13 Then little children were brought to Jesus for him to place his hands on them and pray for them. But the disciples rebuked those who brought them. 14 Jesus said, "Let the little children come to me, and do not hinder them, for the kingdom of heaven belongs to such as these." 15 When he had placed his hands on them, he went on from there. NIV

RECENTLY WHEN READING THIS PASSAGE I WAS PARTICULARLY DRAWN TO THE WAY, THAT **THE DISCIPLES ACTED / REACTED TOWARDS** THOSE PERSONS WHO BROUGHT THE CHILDREN TO JESUS.

▼ **THEY REBUKED THOSE PEOPLE**

■ THAT THEY ACTED THAT WAY **BECAUSE** THEY WERE **CERTAIN** THAT **THEY KNEW THE MASTER'S MIND** IN THIS PARTICULAR MATTER.

■ **HOWEVER THEY WRONGLY PRESUMED** OR **PREDETERMINED** WHAT CHRIST'S ACTIONS WOULD BE IN THIS MATTER OF BRINGING CHILDREN TO JESUS.

■ IN THEIR MINDS, THEIR ACTION REVEALED THAT THEY HAD ANTICIPATED IN ADVANCE WHAT JESUS RESPONSE WOULD BE TO **THEIR REBUKING THE PEOPLE.**

■ **THEY WRONGLY ANTICIPATED** THAT JESUS WOULD BE PLEASED WITH THEIR ACTION – BUT THE OPPOSITE RESULTED - JESUS WAS VERY DISPLEASED / INDIGNANT– *Mark 10: 14 when Jesus saw this, he was indignant.*

■ **AND THIS RESULTED IN** JESUS **REBUKING** THE DISCIPLES AND COMMANDING THEM?

- How could they be so far removed from the position that Jesus took?
- Had they not observed his love, compassion and genuine concern for people and for complete families?

■ IN THIS THE DISCIPLES **FAILED SO MISERABLY**; THEY MISSED THE MARK.

■ THEIR PRESUMPTION WAS SERIOUSLY MISPLACED *Mark 10:13-16*

BUT THEN I THOUGHT

■ HOW OFTEN **MAN** DOES THE SAME THING AS THE DISCIPLES?

■ AND HOW OFTEN **WE** MIGHT BE GUILTY OF DOING THE SAME?

HUMAN TESTIMONY

- HOW OFTEN BY **OUR PRESUMPTUOUS THOUGHTS** DO WE IN EFFECT TRY TO **RESTRICT** OR **GOVERN** OR **CONTROL THE BOUNDARIES** OF HOW JESUS OR GOD WILL OR SHOULD ACT IN A GIVEN SITUATION?
- HOW MANY TIMES HAVE WE **INNOCENTLY OR UNKNOWNLY PRESUME**, WHAT GOD'S RESPONSE **WOULD BE - AND THEREBY ENDEAVOUR TO GOVERN HOW HE SHOULD OR WOULD ACT?**
- **HOW OFTEN DO WE DO THAT** WITHOUT CONSCIOUSLY KNOWING THAT WE ARE DOING EXACTLY THAT?

THINK ABOUT THAT

- **WE NEED TO BE VERY CAREFUL ABOUT PREDICTING WHAT JESUS WILL DO - DESIRES TO DO - IN ANY GIVEN SITUATION.**
- FOR US TO BELIEVE THAT JESUS' ATTITUDE TOWARDS CERTAIN PEOPLE WILL, BE ONE OF ANTAGONISM OR FRUSTRATION OR REJECTION **WOULD ENTIRELY WRONG.**
- YET WE FILTER HOW JESUS OR GOD MIGHT ACT **THROUGH OUR OWN PERSONAL PRECEPTIONS OR PREFERENCES – which so far removed from the truth.**

HUMAN BEHAVIOUR

- ▼ We can think that forgiveness has a cut off point after forgiving several times – **But Jesus says for us to forgive 70 times 7**– meaning there is no point where we can stop forgiving.
- ▼ We think Jesus is too busy with his mission and does not have sufficient time to spend with children or ME, **But how far removed that is from the teaching of Jesus and his example.**
- ▼ How often do we allow what God or Jesus said to be interpreted or FILTERED by our personal preferences, resulting in poor understanding how God will really act?
Example” Jesus said” **“You have heard that it was said, - BUT I SAY TO YOU”, Matthew 5:38 /39 Matthew 5:43/44 ESV**
- ▼ People say or write many things from their perspective, **BUT it is what Jesus/God says that COUNTS**, and not our perceptions.
- ▼ Do we sometimes tend to think or even pray that God only cares for the lives of the righteous, BUT Jesus said **his father causes his Sun to shine and sends his rain to fall on the JUST and the UNJUST.** Matthew 5:45 Matthew 5:48

ACTION required:

- GOD WILL ALWAYS ACT CONSISTENT WITH WHO HE IS, HIS PERSON, HIS NATURE OF FAITHFULNESS, TRUTHFULNESS AND MERCIFULNESS AND FAIRNESS (JUSTNESS).
- **BUT**, THE MANNER or STYLE IN WHICH HE WISELY, TENDERLY AND COMPASSIONATELY APPLIES THOSE ATTRIBUTES IS SOMETHING THAT WE SHOULD NOT PRESUME OR INTRUDE UPON, **BUT LEARN TO TRUST HIM TO DO IT HIS WAY.**
- THAT FROM OUR PERSPECTIVE WE DO NOT **PRESUME** HOW GOD WILL **ACT** OR **RESPOND** IN ANY GIVEN SITUATION.
- LET US STOP TRYING TO PRE-DETERMINE THINGS BEFORE THEY HAPPEN AND JUST - LET GOD BE GOD.
- **THAT WAY, WE WILL HAVE LESS STRESS AND WORRY**

Amen – Ps Barry

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